

Product Intern

Product Teardown — Subspace.money

Thesis

After using Subspace as a first-time user, my biggest takeaway was that the product appears to have strong underlying utility through subscription sharing, group finance and marketplace capabilities, but the value proposition is not communicated early enough. Most friction observed stems from users being asked for trust (location, login and wallet interactions) before they fully understand the product.

Feedback 1 — GTM & ICP

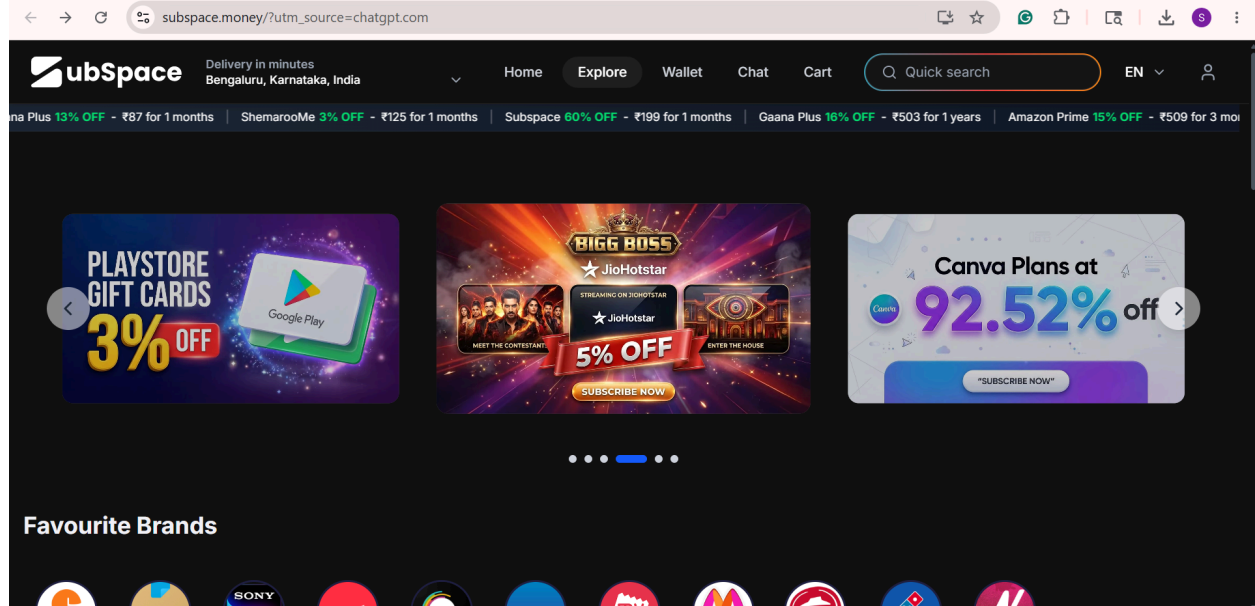
Observed

The first interaction on the website is a location selection prompt. Immediately after that, users land on a page displaying discounted subscriptions, gift cards and offers.

As a first-time visitor, it was not immediately clear whether Subspace is:

- A subscription marketplace
- A subscription management platform
- A group-buying platform
- A digital commerce platform

The homepage assumes product understanding before establishing it.



Problem

Users cannot form a clear mental model of the product within the first few seconds.

When users are unable to understand what a product does, they struggle to determine whether it is relevant to them. This increases bounce rate and reduces activation.

The platform appears to solve multiple problems, but the value proposition is not communicated in a clear order.

Ship Instead

Build a dedicated landing experience before the Explore marketplace.

Suggested Hero Copy:

"Save money on subscriptions, memberships and digital services."

Supporting Copy:

"Discover, share and manage recurring subscriptions in one place."

Only after users understand the value proposition should they be directed into the marketplace experience.

Priority

P0

Feedback 2 — UX

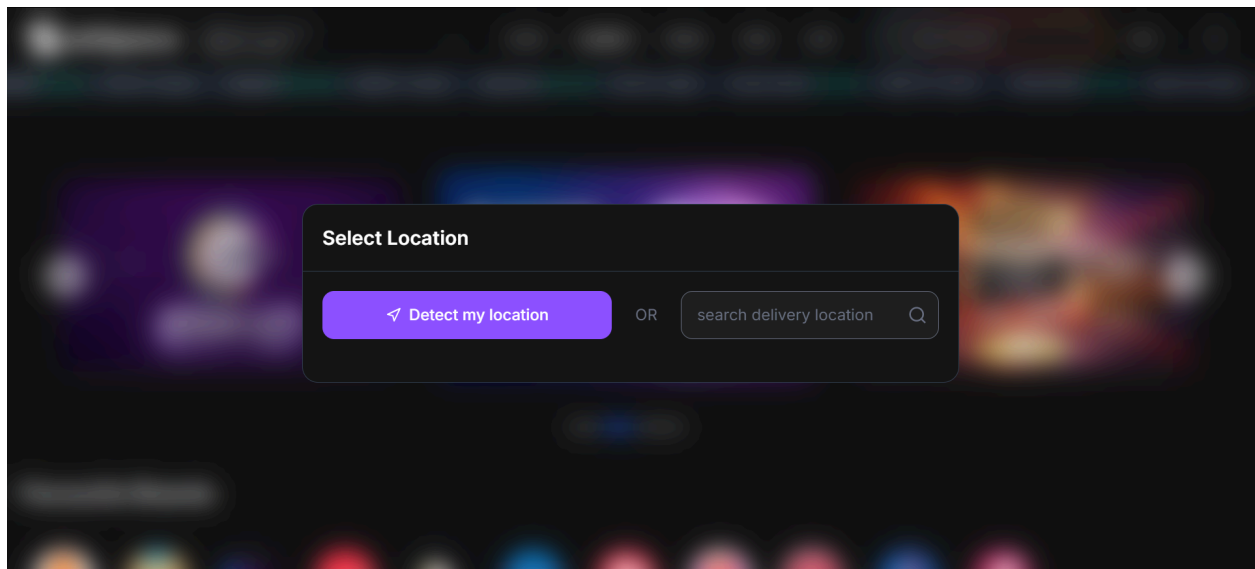
Observed

The website requests location access before the user understands why location is required.

Additionally, the search field uses the placeholder:

"Search Delivery Location"

without specifying whether users should enter a city, locality or pincode.



Problem

Trust and value are out of sequence.

Users are being asked to provide personal information before receiving enough value or context.

This creates unnecessary onboarding friction during the most critical stage of the user journey.

Ship Instead

Delay location requests until they are genuinely needed, such as:

- Product availability checks
- Checkout
- Redemption flows

Replace:

"Search Delivery Location"

with:

"Enter City, Locality or Pincode"

Also explain why location is being requested:

"We use your location to show subscriptions and offers available in your area."

Priority

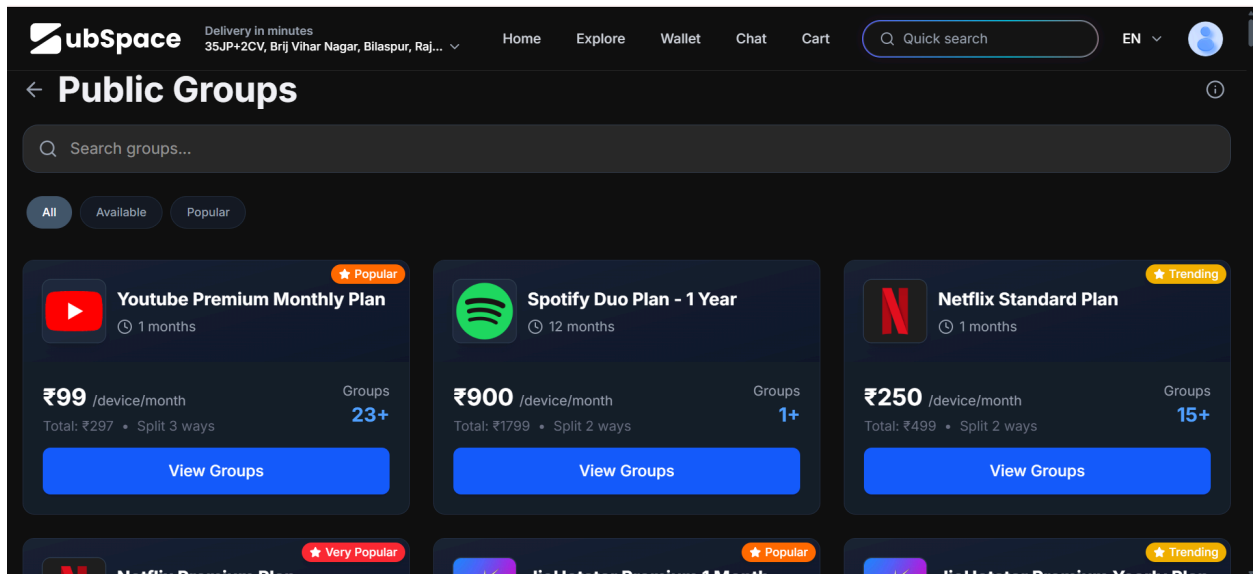
P0

Feedback 3 — Features & Services

Observed

The Public Groups feature displays subscription plans and pricing but does not clearly explain:

- What Public Groups are
- How subscription sharing works
- Who owns the subscription
- What happens if members leave
- How access is managed



Problem

This appears to be one of Subspace's strongest differentiators, yet users are expected to understand the feature without onboarding.

Because the feature involves money and shared ownership, lack of clarity creates hesitation and reduces adoption.

Ship Instead

Add a simple explainer section directly above Public Groups.

Example:

"Join existing subscription groups and split subscription costs with verified members."

Follow it with a visual 4-step journey:

1. Join Group
2. Pay Your Share
3. Receive Access
4. Renew Together

This would significantly reduce cognitive load and improve adoption.

Priority

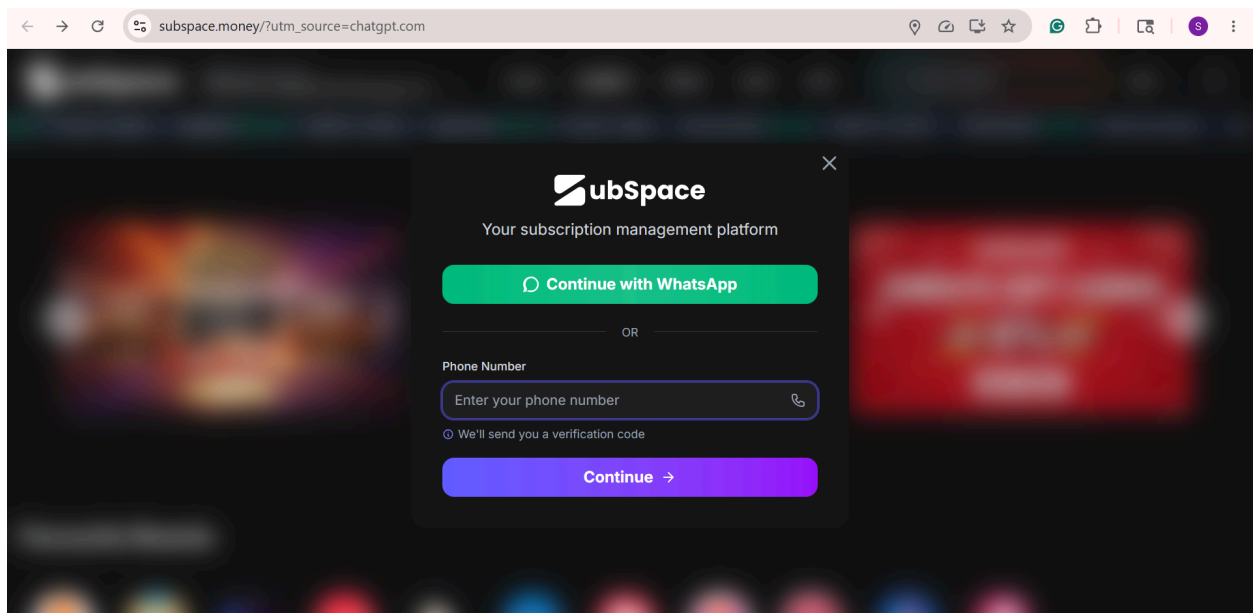
P0

Feedback 4 — UX & Trust

Observed

The login modal asks users for a phone number but does not explicitly explain whether the action is for login, signup or verification.

Alternative login methods such as Google or Email are also unavailable.



Problem

Subspace operates in a financial environment where trust is critical.

Phone numbers are closely associated with banking, UPI and identity verification. Asking for one without sufficient context may create hesitation.

The absence of alternative login methods also introduces unnecessary friction.

Ship Instead

Change the CTA to:

"Continue with Phone Number"

Supporting copy:

"We'll use OTP verification to securely create or access your account."

Additionally, provide:

- Continue with Google
- Continue with Email

This reduces perceived risk while improving conversion.

Priority

P1

Feedback 5 — Wallet Experience

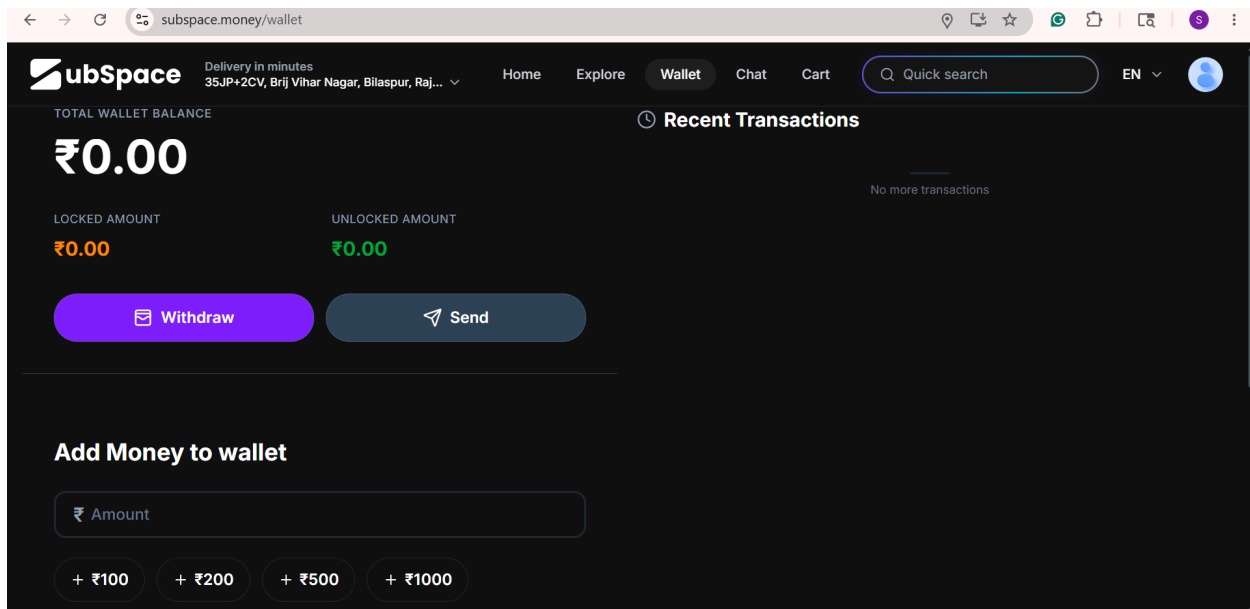
Observed

The wallet interface introduces two balances:

- Locked Amount
- Unlocked Amount

without explaining what either term means.

Similarly, users are prompted to add money to the wallet without understanding which payment methods are supported.



Problem

Financial products must minimise ambiguity.

When users see terms like "Locked Amount" without explanation, it creates uncertainty around fund accessibility and wallet safety.

This can discourage wallet adoption.

Ship Instead

Add contextual tooltips:

Locked Amount

"Funds reserved for active purchases or pending transactions."

Unlocked Amount

"Funds available for withdrawal or purchases."

Also clearly display supported payment methods before users initiate a deposit:

- UPI
- Debit Card
- Credit Card
- Net Banking

As an additional growth lever, surface cashback or wallet reward campaigns to encourage first deposits.

Priority

P1

Feedback	Pillar	Priority
Product positioning & homepage clarity	GTM & ICP	P0
Location access before value	UX	P0
Public Groups explainability	Features / Services	P0
Login trust & onboarding	UX	P1
Wallet transparency	Features / Services	P1

Closing Note

I intentionally focused on activation, trust and product comprehension rather than visual design issues.

My core observation is that Subspace repeatedly asks users to trust the platform before helping them understand its value. This makes the user think 'Why should it use Subspace instead of Splitwise + UPI + a subscription marketplace?'

By improving product communication, onboarding clarity and feature explainability, I believe Subspace can improve activation, reduce friction and better showcase its strongest differentiator: making subscriptions more affordable through sharing and intelligent management.